

Governance Layer — "Brutus the Bouncer"

Legal status (founders' decision, 2026-08-02): policies are self-drafted and binding on the build. They are living documents, refined as the club grows and revenue allows. There is **no external legal-review gate** before launch: a lawyer's sign-off does not shield the club from liability, and the operating shield is the policy language itself (disclaimers, as-is liability, external-activity terms) — which is already drafted. Early-stage apps commonly iterate policies with counsel only once revenue supports it. The voice is the club's. The substance is real.

What this is

The rules of the club, written down *before* the code, so the code is built to fit them — not the other way around. Every governance decision that shapes schema or flow is locked here and enforced in Phase 1+.

The framing (all nightclub, all the time)

- **Brutus the Bouncer conducts the check.** ID + selfie at the door. He asks the questions, launches the verification process, gets the consent checkmark. Quick and painless — no sweat, you're a VIP.
- **Everyone gets checked.** It's nightclub normality. Verification isn't a penalty; it's what makes the room safe enough to have fun in.
- **We're the guy collecting keys at the party.** All this governance is for the members' own protection — nobody wants to be the reason the vibe dies.
- **Trying to sneak past Brutus = bounced.** People who game the system are exactly who the club doesn't want in it. That's the point, and it's the brand.

Document index

Doc	What it locks
terms.md	The Rules of the Club — membership, subscriptions, tokens, conduct, bouncing
privacy.md	What the Bouncer Knows — data collected, why, rights
verification-age.md	The Door Check — 18+, ID + selfie, biometric handling, consent
community-safety.md	Keeping the floor safe — conduct, report/block/ban, no-follow-up rule
data-retention-deletion.md	The Key Return — retention windows, account deletion
refunds-tokens.md	House rules on the house currency — refunds, no-match, cancellations
best-practices.md	Best practices + external-activity disclaimer —

Doc	What it locks
	acknowledged at signup (v1)
<code>aup-enforcement.md</code>	How AUP violations are detected, enforced, and minimized — the controls behind <code>/aup</code> , answerable to reviewers
<code>stripe-prohibited-activities.md</code>	Stripe submission — protocols for trafficking, illegal acts, impersonation, and CSAM (one document, per-section copy-paste)

Code-shaping decisions (locked before Phase 1 schema)

Decision	Policy
Age	18+ hard gate at signup. Birthday collected. No minors, period.
Verification data	We never store the ID docs, selfies, or ID numbers. Stripe Identity runs the check (ID number lookup — US SSN currently; selfie method available for international coverage). We store <code>verified_at</code> + provider reference + result only. Raw biometric material is not retained by us.
Consent	Explicit, separate checkbox for verification/biometric processing — never buried in ToS.
Account deletion	In-app. Profile PII wiped/de-identified. A de-identified fraud/ban flag may remain.
Cancellation	One-click cancel from Account, always visible, no confirmation-begging. (FTC Click-to-Cancel compliant.)
Refunds	No-match events auto-refund tokens, privately. Event canceled for low fill = auto-refund. Token packs follow Stripe's process; monetary disputes are Stripe's, we intervene on escalations.
Retention	Chats: member-chosen (3 days–3 months), set at profile creation; stricter participant's window applies to shared conversations (v1). Token ledger: 7 years (financial records floor). Verification result: retained for fraud prevention, de-identified on deletion.
Bouncing	Warning → temporary ban → permanent removal. All appeals decided case-by-case, fairness first. Human in the loop, no secret bans.
No-follow-up rule	A decline closes the chat. No re-messaging, no re-pairing in consecutive rounds. Enforced in code.

How it's enforced

- **In code:** RLS, consent records, verification state, report/block/ban tables, refund logic — built to these policies in Phase 1–2.
- **In product voice:** every governance surface is framed as club procedure (Brutus checks the ID, the club holds the keys, conduct rules are the vibe).
- **In operations:** moderation escalation path, ban appeals, data-deletion requests — defined in `community-safety.md` and `data-retention-deletion.md`.